

Rebecca Kamen

Rebecca Kamen, an artist who has dyslexia, is fascinated with neuroscience and how cells significantly control cognitive function. fMRI images have shown that the area of the brain that translates words and letters into language does not function in the same way in those with dyslexia, leading to difficulty learning to read...Studies suggest that people with dyslexia are predisposed to seeing patterns that do not exist in the natural world and that dyslexic brain adaptations can be identified as strengths rather than weaknesses because of this ability. In Brock L. Eide and Fennette F. Eide's important book *The Dyslexic Advantage* (2012; updated 2023), the authors argue that those with dyslexia contain strengths in pattern recognition, episodic memory, and creativity and reject the notion that dyslexia is a disorder...Kamen explores the interrelationship of art and science through their symbiotic interest in patterns providing insight into the world by making connections of disparate ideas. More recently, Kamen, whose many interests extend to connections between art and science, investigated language processing at the University of Pennsylvania's Department of Physics and Astronomy. Collaborating with researcher Dale Zhou, they explored Kamen's "information seeking and idea generation process." The result was an AI-generated animation of Kamen's thought process, which showed her unique ability to connect disparate concepts. Rebecca Kamen values difference and seeks to find beauty in exploring the human body's ability to adapt.

—Timothy W. Hiles, *Art, Movement, and Disability: Transcending the Beauty Paradigm*, (New York: Routledge Press, 2026), p. 102-103.

Early childhood memories of exploring the world through a microscope and telescope instilled a deep sense of awe and wonder, planting seeds that continue to influence and advance Kamen's art/science practice. Scientific observations expressed through the language of art and personal vision, allow her to link and transform the similarity and significance of patterns in art and nature. Investigating nature as a dynamic mapping system, her artwork reimagines what scientists see. The ideas generated by curiosity and observation are then translated into abstract shapes. Vibrant color and complexity of forms express the dynamic nature of systems and structures. Making the invisible, visible, the artwork reveals the secrets of nature and fosters innovative ways of seeing the poetry in science.